Reading · Part 1 — A New Orchid Discovery

Multilevel · Questions 1–6

Read the text. Fill in each gap with ONE WORD. You must use a word which is somewhere in the rest of the text.

Nature still has many secrets. We uncovered one of them last week. A **(1)** _____ lover found a new species of orchid in Japan. It is unusual to find **(2)** _____ plants in Japan.

Scientists studied the new orchid carefully before confirming that it had never been recorded before. A professor who helped identify the flower said that discoveries like this show there is still much to learn, even in everyday **(3)** _____.

There are 28,000 orchid **(4)** _____ worldwide, growing on every continent except Antarctica, yet new ones are still being found. The orchid family is one of the largest and most varied groups of flowering plants on Earth.

Interestingly, orchids have long held a special place in Japanese culture. The **(5)** _____ is even mentioned in a Japanese poem from the year 759, showing that people have admired these flowers for well over a thousand years.

The discovery of the new **(6)** _____ is good news for scientists who study plant diversity, and it is a reminder that even well-studied countries like Japan can still surprise researchers with something entirely new.

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Answer key

1-plant 2-new 3-places 4-species 5-orchid 6-species

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